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Travel Radio Australia and I'm speaking with a very interesting person here in the UK. It's Deborah Pierce and Deborah, you were telling me that you actually represent Noosa Shire, which is just north of Brisbane, one hour north of Brisbane. It's a beautiful area.

You represent this to people who are coming from the UK and all over the world. Yeah, that's right, I do. So I work for Tourism Noosa here in the UK, sort of increasing awareness of Noosa, the whole Shire, as a destination for the UK visitor to incorporate in their travel plans when they come out to Australia.

Now, Noosa Shire itself, and I mean, I grew up there really back in my teens while I was working on local radio there. And it's such a beautiful place. When I was there back in the 70s, there was one hotel, which is the Surfair Hotel on Recluse Beach.

Or was it Coolumbia? I can't remember now. But it's such a stunningly beautiful natural area, isn't it? Yeah, it is. And I think the word natural there is really, really key.

So the Shire of Noosa have looked after the environment. They are a UNESCO biosphere. They were Queensland's first UNESCO biosphere.

And they've just been awarded Australia's first Earth Certificated Destination. So they really look after the natural environment. So even if you came to Noosa 20-odd years ago, it probably hasn't changed that much.

We have no high rise buildings. We don't really have any chains. Everything is very local.

Whilst accommodation has grown quite substantially since Geoff was last staying there, we have got a range of accommodation from one five-star hotel, which was the Sofitel, just been rebranded as the Elysium Noosa Resort. But we've also got a lot of apartment-style accommodation, everything from five-star right on Main Beach, through to sort of three-and-a-half down to backpacker-style accommodation. So there's a huge range of accommodation now in Noosa for people to come and stay in.

And the local attractions, I know you have the Australia Zoo, which was Steve Irwin's family zoo. It's still going? Yeah, absolutely. We've got Australia Zoo, and that's a fabulous place to come and see because they've got the animal hospital there.

You can also go and stay there in Crocodile Hunters Lodge as well, which is a really lovely experience to do if you've got kids. But then from a natural point of view, what we try and encourage people to understand is that in Noosa, you've got one of the most accessible national parks, at least directly off our main Hastings Street. You can literally walk up a boardwalk into the national park.

You can do a five-kilometre loop around it, completely free of charge. You'll see koalas in the trees. If you look down at the ocean, you're going to see dolphins, whales migrating.

Between July to October, it's the most natural, magical place. Kangaroos are hanging around as well. People want to see that too.

We have got a huge population of kangaroos, and in particular up at the Noosa Everglades. So there's only two Everglades systems in the entire world, one in Florida. They've done a great job of marketing theirs.

We've done a great job of keeping our secret. Twenty-five minutes outside of Noosa, you're in to our Everglades system. We've got a whole colony of great kangaroos up there.

You'll see them all over the place. But not only that, we've got the most magical, reflective waterways that you can just cruise up. You can swim in our Everglades system, and you can learn all about the multiple ecosystems that are up there.

It's absolutely fascinating. The islands off Noosa are stunningly beautiful. Yeah, we have some absolutely amazing islands.

For the UK visitor, we tend to sail Noosa with Garry, or Fraser Island, the world's largest sand island, which is really accessible. Just a 90-minute drive up to Rainbow Beach, where you can get the ferry across to Garry Island. Tell us a bit more about Fraser Island, because what people don't realise is that on certain days, the sands are all different colours, and it's just mind-blowing, the nature there.

Yeah, the nature's absolutely fantastic. So yeah, there's Rainbow Beach that you can go and visit, and you can learn all about the Indigenous people, the Kapi Kapi people, how it was important, and what that significance was. You can also go on to Garry.

You can stay there. You can just go for a day trip there. You can go down for a drive down the beach.

You can spot dingoes. You can go into the rainforest there, learn all about the sort of medicinal nature of everything in the rainforest. And of course, there's a huge, great big saltwater lake right in the middle that you can go for a nice cooling, refreshing dip on.

So yeah, fantastic for a day trip, but also a great place to go and stay for a couple of nights if you've got a bit more time. And one of my favourite places is a little town called Nambour, where I worked when I was 17 on the local radio station 4NA, as it was known then. And we had the famous Big Pineapple, which is still there, the Big Pineapple.

It's a stop for many, many families who are running through the area. They love that. Yeah, absolutely.

It's a well-Instagrammed site these days for people to go and see. So yeah, if you're planning your holidays to Queensland, please don't miss Noosa Hour. We're just 90 minutes drive north of Brisbane, so really, really accessible, easy place to get to.

All the domestic carriers fly into Noosa. You can even fly from Auckland up to Noosa on seasonal flight as well. So yeah, really easy access.

And how can people find out more about Noosa Shire online? They need to go to noosa.com.au. That's N-O-O-S-A. Great. Thank you so much, Deborah.

So many, Deborah Pierce representing Noosa Shire here in the UK, in cold, rainy UK, and everyone's having it. We're just coming into our summer over the December to March, April, May. I mean, it's summer all year, pretty much all year round in Noosa.

Absolutely. Brilliant temperate climate all year round. So warm waters, never really gets below about 20 degrees in the water, and nothing nasty in our waters either.

So you can swim in them all year round. Thanks for being on the program. Thank you so much.